Hanukkah story. Oren Hazan, a freshman lawmaker from Likud (and, reportedly, a former pimp), said the vote "brought out the Hussein in Obama." An illustration that made the rounds on social media showed the president, clad in a *keffiyeh*, stabbing an Israeli soldier in the back. (One of the first people to share it, not surprisingly, was The Shadow.) Netanyahu would later accuse Obama of secretly conspiring with the Palestinians to draft the resolution, though the only evidence he offered was a story from an Egyptian tabloid.

The center-left, as usual, was merely a faint echo of the right. Herzog was invisible: many journalists didn't even bother to seek out his opinion. When he did speak, it was unremarkable. "This is a difficult night for Israel… it seriously harms our capital Jerusalem, the settlement blocs and Israel's status and diplomatic achievements accumulated over the years." Lapid blamed Netanyahu for the diplomatic failure, but he too condemned the resolution. "The nations of the world should know there is no coalition or opposition within Israel," he said. "We won't be forced to act against our national security interests." There was no substantive debate about whether settlements were, in fact, an impediment to Israel's peace and security. Foreign diplomats drew a connection between the American vote and the Amona farce—but Israeli politicians ignored it.

The following Wednesday, 28 December, John Kerry delivered what was billed as a major address on the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. Again, on substance, it was nothing new. He outlined his vision of a two-state solution, a list of parameters that everyone in Israel and Palestine has known for decades. "Ultimately I think the parameters he lays out are well-known to all of us. There are no major surprises," said Michael Herzog, a former Israeli peace negotiator.

But in style, it was a scathing criticism of Israel. Kerry laid some blame on the Palestinians, for inciting violence and for their internal political dysfunction. But he spent nearly an hour castigating the Netanyahu government, particularly its settlement policy. Israel was drifting toward a binational state, he warned, in which the Palestinians would be "separate but unequal"—an ode to the civil rights movement, of course, and thus a powerful phrase for an American diplomat to use. "The settler agenda is defining the future in Israel," Kerry said. "And their stated purpose is clear. They believe in one state: greater Israel."